THE LANTERN OF BLACKWATER COVE

An introductory scenario for Call of Cthulhu / Basic Roleplaying

Introduction

In the autumn of 1925 the fishing town of Blackwater Cove, Massachusetts, is troubled by lights seen on the water at night and by the disappearance of the lighthouse keeper, Elias Thorne. The investigators are hired by his sister, Mrs. Agnes Hale.

GM’s Information

Elias Thorne discovered a drowned idol in the shoals and brought it to the lighthouse. The Sheriff, Amos Dunmore, is a member of the Lantern Society and will mislead the investigators while appearing helpful.

Chapter One: Arrival in Blackwater Cove

Scene: The Sheriff’s Office
Sheriff Amos Dunmore receives the investigators politely. He claims he has the only key to the lighthouse. If the investigators ask for the key, he promises to look for it and bring it to them later; he never intends to do so. A tarnished badge lies on his desk.

NPC: Sheriff Amos Dunmore
A heavy-set man of fifty. STR 70 CON 65 DEX 45 POW 60 SAN 40. Skills: Persuade 60%.

Scene: Hale Boarding House
Mrs. Agnes Hale offers rooms. She gives the investigators a letter from Elias.
Handout 1: Elias’s Letter.

Chapter Two: The Town

Location: Blackwater Gazette Office
If the investigators search the archive they find a 1911 clipping about a shipwreck and a photograph of a brass lantern recovered from the wreck.

Location: Blackwater Docks
At night a mysterious figure in oilskins watches the water. He introduces himself as Jonah Pike and drops a tarnished badge with the lantern sigil when he leaves.

Item: The Lighthouse Key
An iron key. The Sheriff holds it. Only if the investigators obtain the key or break in can they reach the lighthouse interior.

Chapter Three: The Lighthouse

Condition: Entering the lighthouse requires the key, a successful Locksmith roll, or breaking the door.
Scene: The Lighthouse Interior
The lamp room holds the drowned idol. A trapdoor leads to the sea cave.
Twist: The Sheriff’s Betrayal
If the investigators show the Sheriff the secret documents, he attempts to have them arrested.
Ending: Dawn at the Cove
If the idol is cast back into the sea, Elias is released and the lights cease.